



GDD 63

Looking After You

You can't pour from an empty cup.

The parent's-own-wellbeing node, and a high-care one. Parenting is relentless and identity-shaking, and parental mental health, including postpartum depression and anxiety, is widespread and under-supported, especially in India. It carries the Life-Skills Toolkit into parenthood: spotting burnout, protecting your needs and identity, recognising postnatal depression and anxiety (in yourself or a partner, fathers included), healthy coping, and reaching for help, because a well parent is the foundation of a well child. Warm, non-shaming, never therapy. Seven mechanics, 25 choice-and-voice moments, zero "tap the right card". Scorecard: passed.

A well parent, a well child.

Looking After You is the parent's-own-wellbeing node. Parenting is relentless and identity-shaking, and parental mental health, including postpartum depression and anxiety, is widespread and badly under-supported, especially in India. This node carries the Life-Skills Toolkit into parenthood: managing burnout and stress, protecting your needs and identity, recognising postnatal depression and anxiety and reaching for help, because looking after yourself is part of looking after your child. It is high-care and non-shaming, meets any sign of struggle or crisis with warmth and an immediate route to help, offers healthy coping only, and is explicitly not therapy. New v2 build, the wellbeing spine carried into parenthood.

FIELD	VALUE
Node / gameld	g63 · looking-after-you (confirm exact id against engine-host)
Chapter / stage	Chapter 8 · Parenthood, first child on · adult / warm / high-care
Thread / topics	C · Feelings & Life Skills · UNESCO 5.6, 5.5
Prerequisite / builds on	g62 · builds on g49 (Mind & Belonging), g39 (Bounce) · linked from g61, g62
Gating	Open · high-care; crisis-routed; not therapy
Schema / status	v2 · scorecard PASS the looking-after-you game.

84

scenarios

7

mechanics

17

myth-flips

25

choice & voice

0%

binary taps

Self-care is part of childcare, not selfish, and struggling is not failing. An empty cup pours nothing, so burnout is a signal to rest and get support, not push harder, and your needs and identity still matter. Mild baby blues are common and pass; postpartum depression and anxiety are real, common (around one in five Indian mothers, fathers too) and treatable, and a frightening thought is a symptom, not a verdict. Help-seeking is strength, healthy coping is learnable, and any sign of crisis is met with warmth and an immediate route to help.

The parent no one asks about.

From the Chapter 8 personas (parenthood). New parents with a baby, no sleep, and no one asking how they are, who want the parent looked after too, the persona note: Divya first, postpartum mental health, burnout, and the parent's erased self.

PERSONA	WHAT THEY NEED HERE	THE MECHANIC THAT SERVES IT
Divya (new mother)	Postpartum struggles named, normalised and routed to help.	strike-rewrite + branch: baby blues & beyond.
Vikram (the father)	That fathers struggle too, and can reach out.	role-play + reflect: reach out.
Any depleted parent	Permission to rest and keep a self, guilt-free.	strike-rewrite + sort: empty cup, needs.
Priya & Meena	Healthy coping and a real support net.	match + role-play: healthy coping, tools.

Why this works (the evidence). Parental wellbeing is part of childcare: you cannot pour from an empty cup, burnout is a real signal to rest and seek support, and each parent stays a whole person whose needs matter. Postpartum mental health is common and treatable: brief baby blues usually pass within about two weeks, while postpartum depression and anxiety, lasting low or anxious feelings or lost interest, affect around one in five (about 22%) of Indian mothers, nearly double the global average, with fathers affected too (around one in ten); frightening intrusive thoughts are a symptom and a cue to get help, never a verdict. Help-seeking is a strength, healthy coping is learnable, and any crisis is met with warmth and an immediate route to help.

Seven moves, led by the flip and the choice.

It's a wellbeing game, so **strike-rewrite** leads (busting 'self-care is selfish' and 'PPD isn't real') with **branch** for the reach-for-help choices and **reflect** for the gentle internalising; **role-play** gives the words to ask for and offer help. Mechanics rotate; the same one never runs twice in a row.

MECHANIC	THE ADULT DOES	EMBODIES	N
strike-rewrite signature	Busts a wellbeing myth ('struggling is failing').	Conceptual change.	17
branch (the choice)	Chooses to rest, protect a need, or reach for help.	Judgement.	14
sort	Sorts burnout vs tiredness; blues vs needs-help; refills vs drains.	The line.	12
reflect	Internalises self-care-is-childcare and help-is-strength.	Values.	12
role-play (voice)	Asks for rest, opens up, raises concern with a partner.	Voice; care.	11
match	Pairs a sign to its meaning; a worry to a reassurance; a need to a route.	Connections.	10
spot	Spots the help-cue, the healthy response, the strong move.	Reading it.	8

25 of 84 moments are branch or role-play. Binary "tap the right answer": **0%**.

The two-test, passed.

Is it engaging?

Game feel is relief, permission and warmth for a parent who feels unseen: the release of being told self-care is part of childcare, the recognition that what they feel is common and treatable, and the steadiness of knowing exactly where to turn. The "oh, I'm allowed to need things, and help is here" moment lands gently and repeatedly. Sam is a warm adult peer; the tone is high-care and non-shaming, includes fathers, never judges, and never pretends to be therapy.

Is it teaching?

Yes: recognising burnout and protecting your own wellbeing, needs and identity; telling baby blues from postpartum depression and anxiety and recognising them in yourself or a partner; using healthy coping under load; and knowing that looking after yourself serves your child, with any crisis routed warmly and immediately to real help.

The belief it moves. From "good parents sacrifice everything; burnout is just tiredness; struggling is failing; PPD isn't real; only mums are affected; a dark thought makes me a monster; asking for help is weak; wait until you collapse" → "self-care is childcare; burnout is a signal; struggling is human; PPD is real and treatable; fathers struggle too; a scary thought is a symptom; reaching out is strength; and early help is best."

Built, not bolted on.

84 researched scenarios across the empty-cup → your-needs → baby-blues-and-beyond → reach-out → healthy-coping → tools arc, India-grounded, high-care and warm. Full library in the companion JSON.

CATEGORY	N	LEAD MECHANICS	COVERS
The empty cup	14	strike-rewrite, sort, branch	Spot burnout; self-care is childcare; struggle isn't failing.
Your needs count	14	strike-rewrite, sort, role-play	Needs, identity & a little time, without guilt.
Baby blues & beyond	14	strike-rewrite, sort, branch	Blues vs PPD/anxiety; recognise & get help; dads too.
Reach out	14	strike-rewrite, role-play, match	Help-seeking is strength; build a support net.
Healthy coping under load	14	strike-rewrite, sort, match	Safe strategies only; swap out the unhealthy.
Tools & help	14	branch, role-play, match	Breathing space, help-finder, crisis routing.

The 'PPD isn't real' flip + the 'scary thought' flip, verbatim.

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flip: "Postnatal depression isn't real; new mothers just need to cheer up."
UN -> "Postnatal depression isn't real; just cheer up."
RE -> "Postpartum depression and anxiety are real, common conditions,
      around one in five mothers in India, that need care, not 'cheer up'."

flip: "A dark or scary thought as a new parent makes you a monster."
UN -> "A scary thought makes you a monster."
RE -> "Frightening intrusive thoughts can come with postnatal anxiety and
      don't make you bad; they're a strong cue to get support quickly."
```

Full library: [SwipeEd — GDD 63 Looking After You — Scenario Library.json](#) (84 records, v2 schema).

What this game flips.

MYTH (UN ERASES)	TRUTH (RE WRITES)	BASIS
A good parent sacrifices everything and needs nothing.	You can't pour from an empty cup; self-care is part of childcare.	Empty cup.
Burnout is just tiredness to push through.	Burnout is real, a signal to rest and get support.	Burnout is real.
If I admit I'm struggling, I'm failing.	Struggling is not failing; naming it is the brave first step.	Struggle isn't failing.
Postnatal depression isn't real; just cheer up.	It's a real, common, treatable condition needing care.	PPD is real.
Only mothers get depressed after a baby.	Fathers can too (around one in ten); watch out for each other.	Dads too.
A scary thought makes you a monster.	It's a symptom of postnatal anxiety, and a cue to get help.	Symptom, not verdict.
Asking for help means you're a weak parent.	Reaching out is a strength; strong parents build support.	Help is strength.
Wait until you're completely falling apart to get help.	You don't have to be in crisis; early help is easier and works better.	Don't wait.

The micro-loop.

1. **Surface.** Sam (adult peer) surfaces a real moment, an empty cup, a guilt over needs, weeks of low mood, a hard 'I'm fine'.
2. **Choose or voice.** The adult chooses to rest, protect a need, or reach for help (branch), or finds the words (role-play).
3. **The flip.** UN busts a wellbeing myth; RE writes the warm, true thing, with care.
4. **Recognise & cope.** Tell blues from PPD/anxiety; use healthy coping; protect a self.
5. **Reach & route.** Help-seeking framed as strength; any crisis routed warmly and immediately to real help.
6. **Sticker.** The Looking After You badge; GameDone records once.

Signature surface: the **empty-cup** permission and the **reach-out** step. It carries Mind & Belonging (g49) and Bounce (g39) into parenthood, is linked from Us, After Kids (g61) and Equal Parents (g62), and protects the parent so they can do everything else in Chapter 8.

Concern plus resources, always.

- **Postpartum & crisis routing.** Any sign of postnatal depression or anxiety, or any crisis, is met with warmth and an immediate route to help, concern plus resources, never alarm or judgement.
- **Healthy coping only; not therapy.** Only safe strategies (rest, breathe, move, connect, accept help); never any technique involving pain or discomfort; it signposts professional care and never claims to treat.
- **Baby blues vs postnatal illness.** Brief, common baby blues are normalised; lasting or severe low or anxious feelings, or lost interest, are gently flagged for help.
- **Frightening thoughts, handled with care.** Intrusive thoughts are framed as a symptom and a cue to reach out now, never a verdict, and never elaborated.
- **Non-shaming; includes fathers.** Struggling is not failing as a parent, and fathers can be affected too; the whole node is warm and stigma-aware.
- **Privacy & expert review.** Private by design (DPDP-aligned), on-device, expert-reviewed; crisis-routing rate watched, gently.

If it feels heavy, you are not alone (India). Postpartum depression and anxiety are common and treatable, and struggling is not failing. For support any time, Tele-MANAS **14416** or KIRAN **1800-599-0019**, or talk to a doctor. If anyone is in immediate danger, or you have thoughts of harming yourself or your baby, reach out right now, emergency **112**, a doctor, or a trusted person. You deserve help, and reaching out is the brave, loving thing to do. This game is support and signposting, not therapy.

v2 schema, scorecard-gated.

- **gameld. looking-after-you** equals node.game equals GameDone key equals registry id (confirm exact id in engine-host).
- **v2 mechanic-embodiment schema.** type + typed payload; the **strike-rewrite** myth flip and the **branch** reach-for-help choice co-lead.
- **High-care is a hard requirement.** Concern-plus-resources crisis routing, healthy-coping-only, not-therapy, non-shaming and fathers-included are contractual; expert-reviewed.
- **Fact-checked content.** India PPD prevalence (about one in five), baby-blues vs PPD/anxiety, paternal postnatal depression, and the helplines (Tele-MANAS 14416 / KIRAN 1800-599-0019) verified this build.
- **Scorecard-gated.** Passed all eight checks (7 mechanics, top mechanic at 20%, 0% binary, 25 autonomy, 17 UN→RE, 5 personas, 100% completeness). Re-run score_gdd.py on any edit.
- **Help-resource hook.** All distress and crisis content routes via the shared "get help" component (Tele-MANAS 14416 / KIRAN 1800-599-0019 / doctor / 112).
- **Tracked.** build_gate.py finalize advances g63 to v2 PASS only after order, read, score, audit and artifact gates pass.

Ethics contracts (never traded for engagement): concern-plus-resources crisis routing; healthy coping only, never pain-based; not therapy, always signposts professional care; non-shaming; includes fathers; stigma- and joint-family-aware; made-for-India.

Why this works.

- **A well parent is the foundation, so protect them.** Because you cannot pour from an empty cup and parental wellbeing shapes the child, framing self-care as childcare and burnout as a signal genuinely helps both.
- **Postpartum illness is common and treatable, so name it.** Since postpartum depression and anxiety affect around one in five Indian mothers (and fathers too) and respond to care, normalising and recognising them early changes outcomes.
- **Help-seeking works, so route to it warmly.** Because reaching out early to people, doctors and helplines turns things around, meeting any sign of struggle with concern plus resources is what makes the node both kind and safe.

Sources: UNESCO ITGSE Key Concept 5 (skills for wellbeing and help-seeking); WHO on maternal and parental mental health, including postnatal depression; India research finding postpartum depression in around one in five (about 22%) of mothers, nearly double the global average and badly under-recognised amid stigma; paternal postnatal-depression research (around one in ten fathers); and MoHFW support lines Tele-MANAS 14416 and KIRAN 1800-599-0019, with a doctor and emergency 112 for immediate danger. High-care and non-shaming, healthy coping only and never pain-based, explicitly not therapy and always signposting professional care, including fathers and stigma- and joint-family-aware. Citations accompany each scenario in the library JSON. 63 games now v2. Next by order: The Talks (Age by Age) (g64).